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**UNIVERSITY OF INFORMATION
TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCES**

Software Requirements Specification for

Course Code: CSE 356

Course Title: Software Engineering and System Analysis Lab.

Session: Spring 2026

Batch: 54

Project Title: Hire Harmony (A Web Based Application for Resume Matching)

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Revision History

Name Date Reason For Changes Version			

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose

This document provides a detailed description of the software requirements for Hire Harmony, a web-based resume matching system. The system allows recruiters to post job openings and enables candidates to upload resumes that will be automatically analyzed and matched with job descriptions.

The purpose of this SRS is to describe the functional and non-functional requirements of the system to guide developers, testers, and stakeholders during the development process.

1.2 Document Conventions

To maintain consistency throughout this document, the following conventions apply:

- Each functional requirement is identified by a unique tag in the format REQ-X.
- Requirements are grouped by feature area for easier navigation.
- Every requirement carries one of three priority levels:
- High-core functionality the system cannot operate without
- Medium – important features that significantly enhance the system

1.3 Intended Audience and Reading Suggestions

This document serves multiple groups of readers, each with different goals in mind.

- **Developers** – Use this SRS as the primary technical reference to understand what the system must do and how its components should behave.
- **Project Managers** – Use it to track scope, set milestones, and keep the team aligned with the project vision.
- **Testers** – Treat each stated requirement as something that must be verified; this document is the foundation for all test cases.
- **Recruiters & Job Seekers** – Refer to this document to understand what Hire Harmony is capable of and what to expect from the platform.
- **Technical Writers** – Use this SRS to ensure user manuals and help guides accurately reflect system behavior.

Readers are recommended to start with Sections 1 and 2 before moving into the detailed requirements.

1.4 Product Scope

The problem it solves—Finding a job is tough, and screening resumes is even tougher. Reviewing resumes one by one is slow and inconsistent. Hire Harmony takes that burden off recruiters by automatically scoring and ranking applicants.

For recruiters—Post a job, and the system does the heavy lifting, surfacing the strongest candidates so you spend time interviewing, not sorting.

For job seekers – Get real feedback on why your resume may or may not be landing. Know what skills are missing before you keep applying blindly.

The bigger picture:

- Faster hiring cycles with less manual effort
- More consistent, criteria-based candidate evaluation
- A better experience on both sides of the hiring table

2. Overall Description

2.1 Product Perspective

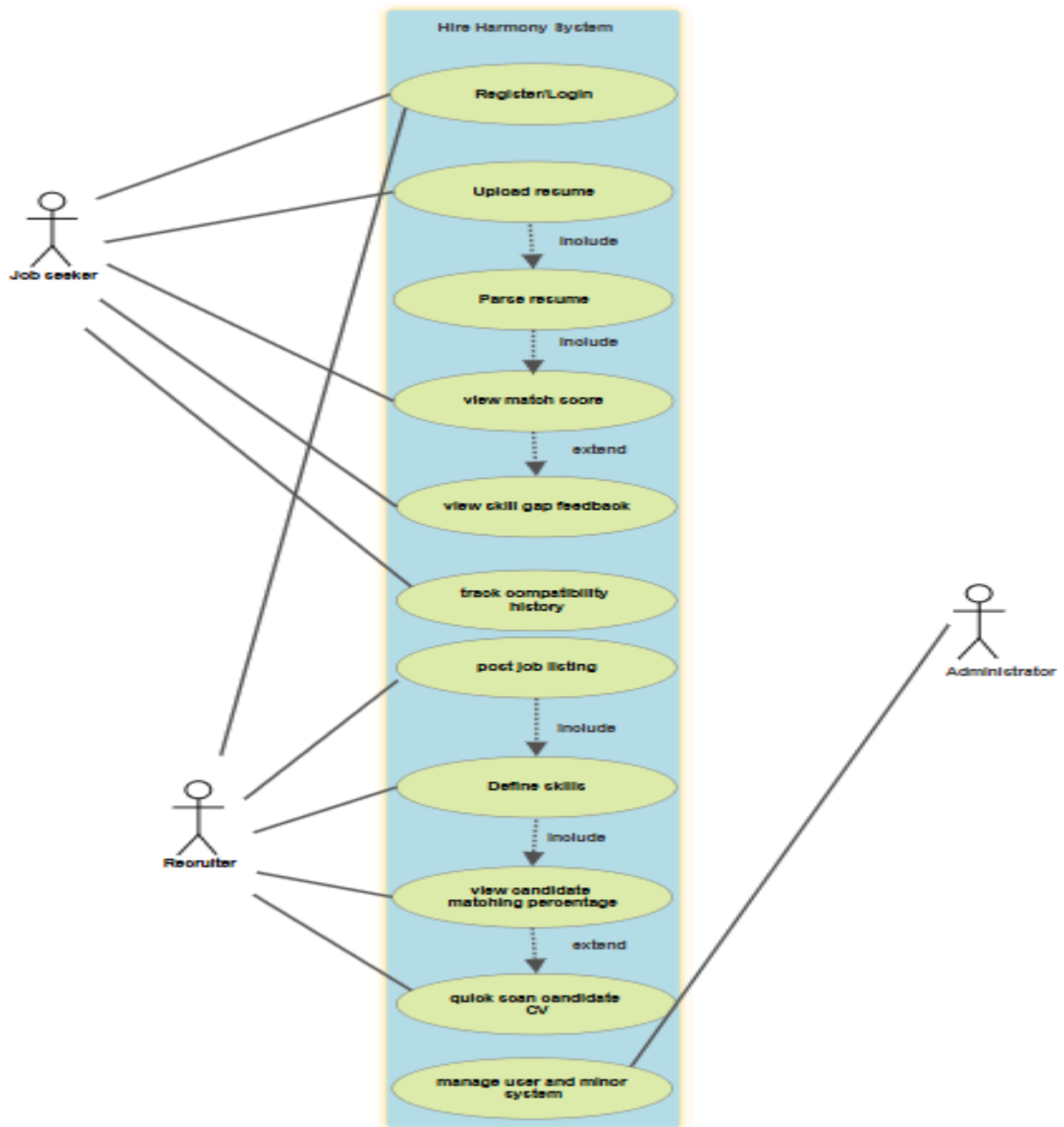
Hire Harmony is a brand-new system—there was no existing tool before it, and it wasn't built to replace anything. The idea came from a simple frustration: manually screening resumes takes too long, relies too heavily on human judgment, and often leads to good candidates being overlooked. This platform was built to fix that.

The system sits between two types of users — recruiters and job seekers — and acts as the intelligent middle layer that connects them. Rather than being part of a larger platform, Hire Harmony is a standalone tool focused specifically on the matching and evaluation stage of hiring.

The major components and how they connect:

- **Web Interface** – The front-facing layer where recruiters post jobs and candidates upload resumes. Built with HTML, CSS, JavaScript and Laravel .
- **Matching Engine** – The core logic of the system. Extracts keywords from resumes and job descriptions, runs similarity comparisons, and produces match scores.
- **Backend (PHP & Laravel)** – Handles business logic, user authentication, file processing, and communication between the interface and the database.
- **Database (MySQL)** – Stores all user data, job postings, parsed resume content, and match results.

Data flows in one direction: user input enters through the web interface, gets processed by the backend and matching engine, and results are stored in the database and surfaced back to the user.



2.2 Product Functions

User Management – Both recruiters and job seekers can register, log in, and manage their own accounts and profiles.

Job Posting – Recruiters can create, edit, and remove job listings with titles, descriptions, and required skills.

Resume Upload – Candidates can upload their resumes in PDF or DOC format directly through the platform.

Resume Parsing – The system automatically extracts relevant keywords and skills from uploaded resumes.

Matching & Scoring – Extracted resume content is compared against job descriptions and a percentage-based match score is generated for each candidate.

Candidate Ranking – Recruiters can view applicants ranked by their match score, making it easy to identify the strongest fits at a glance.

Feedback & Suggestions – Candidates receive automated feedback highlighting skill gaps and missing keywords based on the jobs they are targeting.

Learning Resources – Alongside each identified skill gap, the system provides links to relevant tutorials and learning materials so candidates can immediately act on the feedback they receive.

Admin Controls – A system administrator can monitor activity, manage users, and maintain the overall health of the platform.

2.3 User Classes and Characteristics

- **Recruiters** – The primary power users of the platform. They interact with the system frequently to post job openings, review ranked candidates, and evaluate match scores. Expected to have moderate technical literacy and a clear understanding of what skills and qualifications they are hiring for.
- **Job Seekers (Candidates)** – The other core user group. They may use the platform less frequently than recruiters but their experience is just as critical. They upload resumes, browse job listings, and review feedback and skill gap suggestions. Assumed to have basic computer knowledge with no technical background required.
- **System Administrator** – A behind-the-scenes user responsible for keeping the platform running smoothly. Manages user accounts, monitors system activity, and handles any data or access issues. Expected to have strong technical knowledge of the system's backend and database.

Of the three, recruiters and job seekers are the most important to satisfy — they are the everyday users whose needs drive every design and functionality decision in Hire Harmony. The administrator role, while essential for maintenance, is not part of the core user experience.

2.4 Operating Environment

Hire Harmony is a browser-based application that requires no installation on the user's end. It is built to run on any modern device and operating system, and is designed to coexist with the following environments:

- **Hardware** – Any desktop, laptop, or mobile device capable of running a modern web browser.
- **Operating Systems** – Windows, Linux, and macOS. No specific version restrictions.
- **Browser Support** – Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, and Microsoft Edge.
- **Frontend** – HTML, CSS, and JavaScript running client-side in the browser.
- **Backend** – PHP handling all server-side logic, use laravel as framework and file processing.
- **Database** – MySQL for storing all user, job, resume, and match data.
- **Server** – Apache web server, or XAMPP for local development environments.
- **Communication** – HTTP/HTTPS protocols for all client-server interaction.

The application has no known conflicts with other software. As long as the user has a stable internet connection and a supported browser, the platform is fully accessible without any additional configuration.

2.5 Design and Implementation Constraints

Technology Stack is Fixed – The system must be built using PHP for the backend and MySQL for the database. Developers do not have the flexibility to swap these out for other technologies regardless of preference.

Matching Logic in JavaScript – The keyword extraction and similarity matching must be implemented in JavaScript, keeping the core matching logic on the frontend side.

Supported File Formats – The system must accept resumes in PDF and DOC formats only. Any other file type is out of scope.

Responsive Design Required – The web interface must work across different screen sizes, meaning mobile compatibility is not optional — it is a requirement.

Secure Data Handling – All user data, especially passwords and uploaded files, must be stored and transmitted securely. This limits how data can be handled and rules out any shortcuts in the authentication or file storage process.

Server Environment – The application is expected to run on Apache or XAMPP, which means the codebase must remain compatible with that hosting environment throughout development.

No External Matching APIs – The matching engine must be built from scratch rather than relying on third-party AI or NLP services, keeping the solution self-contained.

2.6 User Documentation

The following documentation will be delivered alongside the Hire Harmony system:

- **User Manual** – A comprehensive guide covering all platform features for both recruiters and job seekers. Will be delivered as a PDF document.
- **System Administrator Guide** – A technical reference for the administrator covering user management, database maintenance, and system monitoring.
- **Installation Guide** – Step-by-step instructions for setting up the application on an Apache or XAMPP server environment. Intended for developers and system administrators.
- **Online Help Guide** – A built-in help section accessible directly from the platform, providing quick answers and guidance without leaving the application.

All documentation will be written in plain, non-technical language where possible to ensure accessibility for users of all backgrounds.

2.7 Assumptions and Dependencies

Assumptions:

- Users have a stable internet connection and access to a modern web browser such as Chrome, Firefox, or Edge.
- Candidates will upload resumes that are reasonably well-structured — the parsing engine is not expected to handle severely malformed or image-only PDF files.

- Recruiters will write job descriptions with enough detail and relevant keywords for the matching engine to work effectively. Vague or one-line job postings will naturally produce less accurate results.
- The system will initially target English-language resumes and job descriptions only. Multilingual support is not in scope for this version.
- Users are assumed to provide accurate information during registration. The system does not verify professional credentials or identities.

Dependencies:

- The application depends on a properly configured Apache or XAMPP server being available and running at all times.
- MySQL must be installed and accessible for all data storage and retrieval operations.
- Browser compatibility is assumed for the three major browsers — Chrome, Firefox, and Edge. Older or niche browsers are not guaranteed to be supported.
- Any third-party resume parsing libraries used must be maintained and compatible with the PHP backend.
- Tutorial links provided alongside skill gap feedback depend on external websites remaining active and accessible. Dead links are outside the system's control.

3. External Interface Requirements

3.1 User Interfaces

Hire Harmony's interface is designed to be clean, intuitive, and accessible to users with no technical background. Every screen follows a consistent layout so that users always know where they are and what they can do next.

General Interface Standards

- A persistent navigation bar appears on every screen, giving users quick access to their dashboard, profile, and logout option.
- All forms include inline validation — users are notified of errors immediately rather than after submission.
- Error messages are displayed in plain language, clearly telling the user what went wrong and how to fix it.
- Standard action buttons (Submit, Cancel, Upload, Save) are consistently placed at the bottom of every form.
- The interface is fully responsive, adapting cleanly to desktop, tablet, and mobile screen sizes.

Key Screens

- **Login & Registration** – Separate entry points for recruiters and job seekers, with clearly labeled fields and a simple sign-up flow.
- **Recruiter Dashboard** – Displays all active job postings and a ranked list of candidates for each, sortable by match score.
- **Job Posting Form** – A structured form where recruiters enter job title, description, and required skills.
- **Candidate Dashboard** – Shows the candidate's uploaded resume, a list of jobs they've been matched to, their scores, and feedback.
- **Resume Upload Screen** – A drag-and-drop or browse-to-upload interface accepting PDF and DOC files.

- **Feedback & Skills Gap Page** – Displays missing skills with direct links to recommended tutorials for each gap identified.
- **Admin Panel** – A separate, access-controlled interface for managing users and monitoring system activity.

3.2 Hardware Interfaces

Hire Harmony is a web-based application and does not directly interface with any specialized hardware. However, the following hardware components play a role in how the system operates:

Client Side

- **Desktop & Laptop Computers** – The primary device through which recruiters and job seekers will access the platform via a web browser.
- **Mobile Devices & Tablets** – The responsive interface ensures the platform remains fully functional on smaller screens without any dedicated app required.
- **File Storage (Local Device)** – When uploading a resume, the system accesses the user's local file system through the browser's native file picker. No direct hardware integration is needed beyond this.

Server Side

- **Web Server** – The application is hosted on an Apache server or XAMPP environment, which handles all incoming requests and serves the application to users.
- **Database Server** – A MySQL database server stores and manages all application data including user accounts, job postings, resumes, and match results.

General

- An active internet connection is required on the client side for the platform to function.
- No proprietary hardware, external devices, or special peripherals are required by either the user or the server to run Hire Harmony.

3.3 Software Interfaces

Web Browsers

- The system is accessed through modern web browsers including Google Chrome, Mozilla Firefox, and Microsoft Edge.
- The frontend communicates with the backend by sending HTTP/HTTPS requests and receiving responses in the form of HTML pages or JSON data.

Backend – PHP

- PHP handles all server-side logic including user authentication, file processing, and database communication.
- It receives input from the frontend, processes it, queries the database, and sends results back to the user interface.

Database – MySQL

- MySQL stores all persistent data including user accounts, job postings, parsed resume content, match scores, and feedback.
- PHP communicates with MySQL using standard SQL queries. Data flows in both directions — written when users submit information and read when results need to be displayed.

Matching Engine – JavaScript

- The keyword extraction and similarity matching logic is handled in JavaScript.
- It takes job description text and parses resume content as input and outputs a numerical match score that gets passed back to the backend for storage.

File Processing Libraries

- Third-party libraries will be used to parse uploaded PDF and DOC resume files and extract raw text content for the matching engine to process.
- The specific library versions will be finalized during the development phase.

Shared Data

- Resume content, job description text, and match scores are the core pieces of data shared across all components — from the frontend upload, through the backend and matching engine, and finally stored in the database and displayed back to the user.

3.4 Communications Interfaces

Protocol

- All communication between the client and server takes place over HTTP/HTTPS. HTTPS is enforced for all data transmission to ensure that sensitive information — such as login credentials and uploaded resumes — is encrypted in transit.

Browser-Server Communication

- The browser sends HTTP requests to the Apache server whenever a user performs an action such as logging in, submitting a form, or uploading a file. The server processes the request and returns a response, which the browser then renders for the user.

File Upload Communication

- Resume files are transmitted from the client to the server using multipart/form-data encoding, which is the standard format for sending files over HTTP. File size limits will be enforced server-side to prevent oversized uploads from affecting performance.

Data Format

- Data exchanged between the frontend and backend is handled through standard HTML form submissions and, where dynamic interaction is needed, JSON-formatted responses.

Security

- HTTPS/TLS encryption is required for all communication channels to protect user data.
- Session tokens are used to maintain authenticated user states and must be transmitted securely with each request.
- Uploaded files are validated and sanitized on the server before any processing begins to prevent malicious file uploads.

Synchronization

- The system follows a standard request-response model. There are no real-time or asynchronous communication requirements at this stage, keeping the communication architecture straightforward and easy to maintain.

4. System Features

The following section describes the major functional features of Hire Harmony, organized by system capability. Each feature is described with its priority, user-system interaction sequences, and detailed functional requirements.

4.1 The Intent-Catcher (Job Portal & Tagging)

4.1.1 Description and Priority This feature serves as a workspace for recruiters to define the core requirements of a role. Priority: **High**. (Benefit: 9, Cost: 4, Risk: 3).

4.1.2 Stimulus/Response Sequences

- **Stimulus:** The recruiter creates a new job posting and adds specific #Must-Have tags.
- **Response:** The system saves the job post and its associated tags to the SQL database for structured storage.

4.1.3 Functional Requirements

- **REQ-1.1:** The system shall provide a web-based portal for recruiters to post jobs.
- **REQ-1.2:** The system shall allow recruiters to input "#Must-Have tags" (e.g., #Python, #TeamLead) when defining a role.
- **REQ-1.3:** The system shall utilize PHP for robust backend processing to handle job postings.

4.2 The Magic Drop (Smart Upload & Parsing)

4.2.1 Description and Priority A drag-and-drop interface that allows candidates to upload their resumes for instant reading and parsing. Priority: **High**. (Benefit: 9, Cost: 5, Risk: 5).

4.2.2 Stimulus/Response Sequences

- **Stimulus:** The candidate drags and drops their resume file into the upload zone.
- **Response:** The system's engine instantly reads and extracts the content from the uploaded file without requiring manual form entry.

4.2.3 Functional Requirements

- **REQ-2.1:** The system shall provide candidates with a drag-and-drop zone to upload resumes.
- **REQ-2.2:** The system shall instantly read the uploaded file without requiring candidates to manually fill out forms.
- **REQ-2.3:** The system shall implement resume parsing and keyword extraction.
- **REQ-2.4:** How the system handles corrupted or unsupported file types is TBD.

4.3 The Harmony Leaderboard (Matching Engine)

4.3.1 Description and Priority A matching engine that ranks candidates based on how perfectly they align with the recruiter's required tags. Priority: **High**. (Benefit: 9, Cost: 7, Risk: 6).

4.3.2 Stimulus/Response Sequences

- **Stimulus:** A recruiter opens their dashboard to view applicants for a specific role.
- **Response:** The system calculates a Harmony Score and displays a ranked list of candidates, placing the highest matches at the top.

4.3.3 Functional Requirements

- **REQ-3.1:** The system shall implement similarity matching logic and keyword extraction using JavaScript.
- **REQ-3.2:** The system shall utilize NLP (Natural Language Processing) for semantic matching.
- **REQ-3.3:** The system shall calculate a "Harmony Score" for each candidate based on their match to the job's tags.
- **REQ-3.4:** The system shall display a ranked list to the recruiter, placing 90% matches at the top in green.
- **REQ-3.5:** The system shall move low relevance resumes out of the recruiter's primary view.

4.4 The X-Ray View (Quick Scan)

4.4.1 Description and Priority A feature that extracts a candidate's vital skills and experiences into a uniform card layout, eliminating the need to open PDF files. Priority: **Medium**. (Benefit: 7, Cost: 4, Risk: 2).

4.4.2 Stimulus/Response Sequences

- **Stimulus:** A recruiter clicks on a matched candidate in the Leaderboard.
- **Response:** The system displays the extracted core skills and experience in a clean card layout.

4.4.3 Functional Requirements

- **REQ-4.1:** The system shall extract the core skills and experience from the parsed resume.
- **REQ-4.2:** The system shall display the extracted candidate "vitals" in a uniform card layout.
- **REQ-4.3:** The system shall allow recruiters to view these details within 5 seconds without downloading a file.

4.5 The Honest Mirror (Candidate Feedback Loop)

4.5.1 Description and Priority An automated feedback mechanism that provides candidates with suggestions on missing skills or keywords to improve their match score. Priority: **High**. (Benefit: 8, Cost: 5, Risk: 3).

4.5.2 Stimulus/Response Sequences

- **Stimulus:** A candidate submits an application that does not perfectly match the job description.
- **Response:** The system displays their match percentage and suggests specific skills or keywords to highlight.

4.5.3 Functional Requirements

- **REQ-5.1:** The system shall calculate and display a match percentage to the candidate.
- **REQ-5.2:** The system shall provide automated suggestions regarding missing skills or keywords.
- **REQ-5.3:** The system shall display specific guidance on how to improve the match score (e.g., suggesting they highlight experience with #React.js or #Agile).

4.6 The Career Compass (Profile Tracking)

4.6.1 Description and Priority A personal dashboard for candidates to track their compatibility history and identify market value. Priority: **Medium**. (Benefit: 6, Cost: 4, Risk: 2).

4.6.2 Stimulus/Response Sequences

- **Stimulus:** The candidate navigates to their personal tracking dashboard.
- **Response:** The system displays which roles they align with best and their overall compatibility history.

4.6.3 Functional Requirements

- **REQ-6.1:** The system shall provide a personal dashboard for candidates.
- **REQ-6.2:** The system shall track and display the candidate's "Compatibility History".
- **REQ-6.3:** The system shall display which roles the candidate aligns with best.
- **REQ-6.4:** The system shall highlight which specific skills the candidate needs to learn to land their desired roles

5. Other Nonfunctional Requirements

5.1 Performance Requirements

- The system must be capable of extracting the core skills and experience from a resume and displaying the candidate's "vitals" in a clean card layout within 5 seconds without requiring a file download.
- The system's parsing engine must be able to read uploaded files instantly upon being dropped into the smart upload zone.
- Backend database performance and scalability must be maintained through proper SQL indexing and normalization.
- The matching engine must quickly calculate Harmony Scores and rank candidates so recruiters can spend their time interviewing rather than scrolling.

5.2 Safety Requirements

- As Hire Harmony is a web-based software application for resume matching, there are no direct physical safety risks associated with its use.
- However, to prevent detrimental data loss or corruption (which could harm the hiring process), the system must utilize structured storage via SQL.

5.3 Security Requirements

- To mitigate significant data privacy concerns, the system must protect user data through secure SQL storage.
- The system must implement password hashing to secure user accounts.
- Data encryption must be utilized to protect sensitive information transmitted and stored within the application.
- A dedicated phase for testing, security, and bug fixing must be completed before deployment to ensure data protection.

5.4 Software Quality Attributes

- **Usability:** The user interface must be intuitive, responsive, and professional, developed using HTML and CSS. The application process for candidates must feel fast and fluid, utilizing a simple drag-and-drop zone rather than lengthy forms.
- **Efficiency:** The system's design must prioritize "Lean Efficiency". It must successfully reduce manual screening time for recruiters by approximately 60-70% through the use of the Harmony Leaderboard.
- **Customizability & Flexibility:** By utilizing an open-source stack, the system must remain highly customizable.
- **Scalability:** The architecture must be designed to support future improvements, allowing the platform to eventually evolve into a fully scalable HR tool.

5.5 Business Rules

Business rules govern candidate-recruiter interactions and system behavior. Recruiters must define at least one #Must-Have tag when creating a job listing. A Harmony Score below a recruiter-defined threshold (default: 40%) will classify the candidate as low relevance. Candidates can apply to multiple jobs but can only upload one active resume per application. The system will not reveal recruiter tag weights to candidates. All matching activity is logged for audit purposes.

5.6 User Requirement

Recruiters and candidates are assumed to have basic familiarity with web browsers and online forms. No technical knowledge is required. Administrators should understand the internals of the application to manage server-side issues such as disk failures or configuration problems. The system must include a user manual, in-app help, and guided onboarding tooltips. Recruiters should receive training on how to use structured tags effectively to improve matching quality.

6. Other Requirements

6.1 Database Requirements

- The system shall utilize SQL for structured data storage to manage users, resumes, jobs, and matches.
- The system architecture may also leverage MongoDB to ensure scalability.
- Proper SQL indexing and normalization must be implemented to maintain performance.

6.2 Legal and Privacy Requirements

- The system must address data privacy concerns associated with handling sensitive candidate information.
- Security measures must include secure SQL storage, password hashing, and data encryption.

6.2 SWOT Analysis

Strengths:

- NLP-based semantic matching provides intelligent resume-to-job alignment
- Open-source and customizable stack reduces licensing cost
- Transparent Harmony Score improves trust between recruiters and candidates
- Structured SQL storage ensures data integrity

Weaknesses:

- Matching logic may require iterative fine-tuning to achieve high accuracy
- Performance depends on quality of resume content and recruiter-defined tags
- Limited advanced AI capabilities compared to commercial ATS platforms

Opportunities:

- Growing enterprise demand for AI-powered recruitment tools
- Potential integration with LinkedIn, Indeed, and other job portals
- Expansion into a full HR SaaS product with subscription tiers

Threats:

- Competition from established commercial ATS vendors
- Potential recruiter resistance to adopting new tooling
- Data privacy regulations (e.g., GDPR) may require compliance updates

6.3 Project Reuse and Licensing

- The project shall be developed utilizing an open-source stack (PHP, SQL, JavaScript) to minimize licensing fees and maximize customizability.
- The platform itself is intended to be an open-source and customizable solution.

6.4 Glossary

- ❖ **Administrator:** refers to a system user with full management privileges, including the ability to manage all user accounts, job postings, and system settings.
- ❖ **Recruiter** :refers to a registered user who creates job postings, defines #Must-Have tags, and reviews ranked candidate applications.
- ❖ **Candidate** :refers to a registered user who uploads their resume and applies to job postings through the platform.
- ❖ **Harmony Score** is a percentage-based similarity score ranging from 0% to 100% that represents how closely a candidate's resume matches the #Must-Have tags of a specific job posting.
- ❖ **Harmony Leaderboard** is the recruiter-facing dashboard view that ranks all applicants for a specific job in descending order of their Harmony Score.
- ❖ **#Must-Have Tags** are structured skill or qualification labels that recruiters attach to a job posting to define the most critical requirements for the role.
- ❖ **X-Ray View** is a uniform card-based display that shows a candidate's key qualifications — including skills, experience, and education — without requiring the recruiter to open or download the original resume file.

- ❖ **Magic Drop** is the drag-and-drop resume upload zone available on the candidate's dashboard.
- ❖ **Honest Mirror** is the automated feedback panel shown to candidates after an application, listing missing keywords and suggestions for improving their Harmony Score.
- ❖ **Career Compass** is the candidate's personal analytics dashboard showing their application history, compatibility scores, and recommended skills to develop.
- ❖ **ATS** stands for Applicant Tracking System, which refers to traditional software used by organizations to manage job applications, typically through basic keyword matching.
- ❖ **NLP** stands for Natural Language Processing, a branch of artificial intelligence that enables computers to understand and interpret human language.
- ❖ **SQL** stands for Structured Query Language, the database language used to create, read, update, and delete records in the system's relational database.
- ❖ **ROI** stands for Return on Investment; in the context of this project, it is measured primarily by the reduction in manual recruiter screening time and the improvement in candidate application quality.
- ❖ **SWOT** is a structured analysis framework evaluating a project's Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Threats.
- ❖ **SaaS** stands for Software as a Service, a software delivery model in which an application is hosted on a remote server and accessed through a web browser, typically on a subscription basis.